Trista

Your new level 2 quick reference

Human Monk 2 (2024 rules)

HP: choose one method before updating the live sheet

Fixed gain: +8 maximum HP, from 11 to 19.

Rolled gain: roll 1d8 + 3 and add it to the previous maximum of 11. Record the die result.

Current HP may be lower after Session 1. Increasing maximum HP does not itself represent a rest.

Numbers and movement

AC 14. Initiative +4. Attack +6; Martial Arts damage 1d6+4. Proficiency remains +2.

Speed becomes 40 ft. while unarmored and without a shield.

New resource

Two Focus Points. Spent points return after a short or long rest.

Uncanny Metabolism: once per long rest when rolling initiative, restore all spent Focus Points and regain 1d6+2 HP.

No subclass yet

Trista chooses a Monk subclass at level 3.

Trista

Choose one bonus action

Human Monk 2 (2024 rules)

Flurry of Blows

Spend 1 Focus Point to make two Unarmed Strikes as one bonus action.

You do not need to take the Attack action first.

Patient Defense

Bonus action Disengage for free; or spend 1 Focus Point to Disengage and Dodge together.

Dodge lasts until the start of your next turn under the normal action rules.

Step of the Wind

Bonus action Dash for free; or spend 1 Focus Point to Dash and Disengage together.

When you spend the point, your jump distance is doubled for that turn.

At the table

You normally have only one bonus action per turn. Choose a normal Martial Arts strike, Flurry, Patient Defense, or Step of the Wind.

Action: attack +6 for 1d6+4. The original level 1 handbook follows; its old speed, HP, and Focus preview are superseded by these first two pages.

TRISTA

THE QUIET HAND

A beginner's guide to your first D&D character

Monk - human - criminal and spy - chaotic good

READ THIS FIRST

Welcome to the Table

No memorization required

You decide what Trista tries. The rules help the table discover what happens.

You do not need to know every rule before playing. You only need to understand Trista well enough to make one choice at a time.

The rhythm of play

1. **The DM describes the situation.**
Listen for what is nearby, what looks dangerous, and what seems uncertain.

2. **Say what Trista tries.**
Describe the goal in ordinary language. You do not need to name a rule or skill.

3. **Roll only if asked.**
The DM tells you which die and modifier to use. Sometimes a good idea simply works.

4. **See what changes.**
Success and failure both move the story. Then someone makes the next choice.

TRISTA IN ONE SENTENCE

A watchful former thief who uses speed, discipline, and compassion to protect people - especially Gundren, the dwarf who once gave her a second chance.

Dice and D20 Tests

d20 + modifier vs. difficulty or Armor Class

Meet or beat the target number to succeed.

Which die does what?

- **d20** — Attacks, ability checks, saving throws, and initiative.
- **d12** — Large damage dice. Trista rarely needs this at level 1.
- **d10** — Damage and some class features; percentile rolls use two d10s.
- **d8** — Trista's Hit Die and some weapons or healing effects.
- **d6** — Trista's Martial Arts damage die at level 1.
- **d4** — Small damage, small bonuses, and some effects.

EXAMPLE: AN ATTACK

Roll d20 + 6. If the total meets the enemy's AC, roll 1d6 + 4 damage. A natural 20 always hits and is a critical hit; a natural 1 always misses.

Three common d20 tests

ATTACK ROLL

Roll d20 + attack bonus against the target's AC. If it hits, roll damage separately.

ABILITY CHECK

Roll d20 + the skill or ability modifier the DM names. Example: Dexterity (Stealth).

SAVING THROW

Roll because danger is happening to Trista. The effect tells you which ability save to use.

ADVANTAGE AND DISADVANTAGE

Advantage: roll two d20s and use the higher. Disadvantage: roll two and use the lower. They normally do not stack.

YOUR CHARACTER SHEET

The Numbers That Matter

Level 1 monk

AC 14

An attack must meet or beat 14 to hit Trista.

HP 11

Damage lowers this. Healing cannot raise it above 11.

SPEED 30 FT.

How far she can move on her turn.

INITIATIVE +4

Add this when combat order is rolled.

ATTACK +6

Add to d20 attacks with dagger or unarmed strike.

DAMAGE 1D6+4

Roll after a hit with Martial Arts or a monk weapon.

STEALTH +6

Sneaking, hiding, and moving quietly.

ACROBATICS +6

Balance, tumbling, and agile movement.

DECEPTION +3

Convincing lies, disguising intent, and misdirection.

How to read an ability

A score such as **Dexterity 18** describes raw ability. The smaller number beside it - the **+4 modifier** - is what you usually add to a roll. Dexterity is Trista's engine: it helps her attacks, damage, initiative, Armor Class, Stealth, and Acrobatics.

STRENGTH lifting, jumping, forcing, resisting a shove

DEXTERITY speed, balance, sneaking, precise attacks

CONSTITUTION endurance, health, resisting poison

INTELLIGENCE remembering facts, study, investigation

WISDOM awareness, instinct, insight, survival

CHARISMA confidence, deception, persuasion, presence

WHEN THE LIVE SHEET CHANGES

Leveling up, equipment, injuries, and campaign rewards can change these numbers. If D&D Beyond and this handbook ever disagree, use the live character sheet and ask the DM.

Anatomy of Your Turn

At the start of each turn, ask: ***Where am I? What can hurt me? Does an ally need help?***

MOVE

Up to 30 feet. Split it before and after your action.

+

ACTION

Usually Attack. You can also Dash, Disengage, Dodge, Help, Hide, Search, Study, Ready, or use an object.

+

BONUS ACTION

Only when a feature allows it. Trista can make one unarmed strike this way.

The action menu

Attack
Make one weapon attack or Unarmed Strike.

Dash
Gain extra movement equal to your Speed this turn.

Disengage
Your movement does not provoke Opportunity Attacks this turn.

Dodge
Attacks against you have Disadvantage; you gain Advantage on Dexterity saves.

Help
Assist an ally's attack or ability check, or administer first aid.

Hide
Make a Dexterity (Stealth) check when the situation permits.

Search / Study
Look for something with Wisdom, or recall/analyze with Intelligence.

Ready
Name a trigger and prepare an action that may use your Reaction.

REACTION

A Reaction happens in response to a trigger, sometimes on another creature's turn. The common example is an Opportunity Attack when a visible enemy leaves your reach. You regain your Reaction at the start of your next turn.

GOOD TO KNOW

You do not have to use every part of a turn. Talking briefly is normally free. Ask before handling a complicated object, and tell the DM when you are finished.

A RELIABLE FIRST CHOICE

Trista's Combat Plan

Two quick attacks at level 1

Move with purpose, strike quickly, and leave room for the rest of the party.

Your default turn

1. **Choose a reachable target.**
Ask the DM how far away it is and whether anything blocks the path.

2. **Move into reach.**
Most melee attacks need the target within 5 feet. You can move before or after attacking.

3. **Action: Attack.**
Roll d20 + 6. On a hit, roll 1d6 + 4 damage with a dagger or Unarmed Strike.

4. **Bonus Action: Unarmed Strike.**
Roll another d20 + 6, then 1d6 + 4 on a hit. It can be a kick, elbow, knee, or palm.

IF YOU ARE SURROUNDED

Do not stand alone if several enemies can reach you. Use Disengage to retreat safely, or Dodge if you must hold your ground.

IF YOU CANNOT REACH

Move, throw a dagger using the range on the live sheet, Dash to close the distance, or Help another character.

PROTECT THE FEATURE

Martial Arts works while Trista is unarmored, has no shield, and is unarmed or wielding only monk weapons.

At level 1, Trista does not yet have Focus Points or Flurry of Blows.

Damage, Healing, and Rest

The hit point path

AC 14

Enemy attack rolls must meet or beat this number.

>

HP 11

Subtract damage from current HP, not the maximum.

>

0 HP

Trista falls Unconscious and begins Death Saving Throws.

At 0 hit points

- At the start of your turn, roll one d20 with no ability modifier.
- 10 or higher is one success. 9 or lower is one failure.
- Three successes make you Stable. Three failures mean death.
- A natural 20 restores 1 HP. A natural 1 counts as two failures.
- Healing restores consciousness and clears successes and failures.

How to stay alive

- Tell the table when you are badly hurt; 11 HP can disappear quickly.
- Do not chase an enemy so far that allies cannot reach you.
- Disengage when leaving an enemy's reach; otherwise it may attack with a Reaction.
- Dodge is useful when survival matters more than dealing damage.
- Cover, distance, doorways, and teamwork are real defenses.

SHORT REST

A pause during which characters can spend Hit Dice to recover HP. Use the controls on the live sheet and ask the DM whether the rest is safe and how many Hit Dice remain.

LONG REST

A full night's recovery in a safe-enough place. It restores many resources. The live sheet applies the exact changes; the DM decides whether the rest completes.

Exploration, Stealth, and Talk

Trista notices doors, hands, exits, and people others overlook.

Describe an approach and a goal. The DM will tell you whether a roll is needed.

Stealth +6
Say where Trista hides, what cover she uses, and how she avoids attention. A high roll does not make her invisible; positioning still matters.

Acrobatics +6
Use it for balance, tumbling, or agile control when the DM calls for it. It is not a universal substitute for climbing or jumping.

Deception +3
State the lie, who should believe it, and what Trista wants them to do. The details matter as much as the number.

Thieves' tools
Use the live sheet when picking a lock or disarming a mechanism. Describe precautions first; some traps punish a careless attempt.

Useful things to say

"What do I notice about the room before I enter?"

"I want to cross unseen; where is the best cover?"

"I watch their hands and tone. Do they seem frightened or dishonest?"

"Before I touch it, can I tell whether it is trapped?"

"Can I help another character with what they are trying?"

"My goal is to get the truth without starting a fight."

A FAILED ROLL IS NOT FAILURE AS A PLAYER

It creates a new situation. Ask what Trista learns, what danger appears, or what choice remains.

MAKE CHOICES LIKE TRISTA

Roleplaying and Teamwork

You may speak in Trista's voice, describe her in third person, or switch between both. All three are real roleplaying.

PERSONALITY

Calm under pressure. She enters a room by noting exits, valuables, lies, and who looks afraid.

IDEAL

Power carries responsibility. Fortune built by crushing others should be used to relieve suffering.

BOND

Gundren bet on her when no one else would. She will not abandon him when he needs that faith returned.

FLAW

Valuable unattended objects test her self-control; curiosity can sound remarkably like permission.

Five questions when you feel stuck

1. **Who in this scene is being ignored or mistreated?**
2. **Where are the exits, hiding places, and unattended valuables?**
3. **Would Gundren be proud of this choice?**
4. **Is this person cruel, frightened, desperate, or all three?**
5. **Can Trista solve this without hurting anyone?**

TEAM RULE

A flaw should create an interesting choice, not remove another player's fun. Do not steal from another player character or split from the group without checking that everyone is comfortable with the scene.

NOT YET - BUT SOON

When Trista Levels Up

A preview, not an active ability list

IMPORTANT

Do not use the abilities below until D&D Beyond shows Trista at the required level. When she levels, read the live feature text with the DM.

Level 2: the monk opens up

FOCUS POINTS: 2

Spend Focus Points on enhanced techniques. All spent points return after a Short or Long Rest. Track them on the live sheet.

FLURRY OF BLOWS

Spend 1 Focus Point to make two Unarmed Strikes as a Bonus Action instead of the normal one.

PATIENT DEFENSE

Take Disengage as a Bonus Action for free, or spend 1 Focus Point to Disengage and Dodge together as a Bonus Action.

STEP OF THE WIND

Take Dash as a Bonus Action for free, or spend 1 Focus Point to Dash and Disengage together and double jump distance.

UNARMORED MOVEMENT

Her Speed increases by 10 feet while she is not wearing armor or using a shield. Her usual 30-foot Speed becomes 40 feet.

UNCANNY METABOLISM

Once per Long Rest when Initiative is rolled, regain all Focus Points and recover HP equal to 1d6 plus monk level.

Level 3: another decision

Trista gains **Deflect Attacks** and chooses a monk subclass. That choice can shape her later identity, so make it with the player and DM rather than treating this handbook as the decision.

Rules basis: D&D Beyond 2024 Free Rules, Playing the Game and Monk class. Live sheet text and DM rulings take precedence.

The Quiet Hand

She learned early that quiet people hear what louder folk miss.

Trista learned young that people rarely remember the quiet person in the room - until something goes missing.

She grew up around smugglers, messengers, card players, and informants. She learned to remember where a key was set down, notice an unlocked window from across a street, and read a room before anyone thought to watch her. Those talents made her useful as a courier and spy, and very good at slipping away unseen.

Wealth itself never interested her as much as what it revealed. Food vanished from merchants who cheated their customers. Coin left the purses of cruel landlords and appeared where hungry families would find it. Trista called that balance. She also knew, if she was honest, that she liked the challenge.

THE PRICE OF A MISTAKE

A Theft Too Costly

One prize was worth more trouble than any purse could repay.

Trista's rules made sense until the night she opened the wrong strongbox. Inside was a sealed ledger - the sort of small, ordinary thing that becomes priceless when it can ruin a powerful person. She took it believing she had found proof of corruption. She discovered too late that several dangerous people believed it belonged to them.

They did not simply ask for it back. They named a debt beyond anything she could steal or earn, then made it clear the sum was only an excuse. They wanted obedience. For the first time, every exit Trista could find led to another locked door.

> ***She kept her face calm. Inside, she understood that cleverness alone would not save her.***

A DEBT REMEMBERED

Someone Willing to Bet

Gundren paid the debt - and asked for nothing but a better choice.

Gundren Rockseeker intervened before Trista learned what her captors intended. He was not a magistrate or a hero from a ballad. He was a practical dwarf with enough coin, nerve, and stubborn decency to make the problem disappear.

When Trista demanded to know why he would spend so much on a thief, Gundren answered as though the matter were obvious:

> ***"Everyone deserves at least one person willing to bet on them."***

Gundren never asked her to become someone else. He left her with a choice. That is why helping him near Phandalin is not just a job; it is the repayment of a kindness no purse could measure.

Discipline, Not Erasure

Discipline did not erase her old talents. It gave them purpose.

Trista left much of her old criminal life behind and sought the discipline of a monastery. Breath, balance, repetition, and restraint gave names to instincts she had once trusted blindly. Her quick hands, watchful eyes, and sense for hiding places remained. They simply began serving a different purpose.

The enormous robes she wears now hide the movement of an exceptionally quick fighter - and, conveniently, more than a few pockets. Her rules are simple: do not steal from people who cannot afford the loss; avoid harm when another answer exists; protect people who cannot protect themselves; and never forget a debt.

The Unfinished Mark

A player-safe beginning

Gundren's sketch shows one circle at its heart and eight around it.

There is one mystery Gundren meant to place before Trista.

During his research, Gundren acquired a black stone medallion carved with one central circle and eight smaller circles. He did not understand it, but he intended to ask Trista for help. Whether she recovers it, accepts it, or entrusts it to someone else will happen in play.

The campaign begins near Phandalin, where Trista is helping escort supplies for Gundren. When that simple job turns dangerous, she will not walk away. Later, Waterdeep may become home: a city of rain, lanterns, old secrets, tempting valuables, and people worth returning to.

Trista does not begin with answers about the mark. She only knows Gundren trusted her judgment - and she intends to find him.

The four rules she keeps

MERCY

Do not hurt someone when another answer exists.

PROTECTION

Stand beside people who cannot protect themselves.

JUSTICE

Do not steal from people who cannot afford the loss.

DEBT

Never forget the person who was willing to bet on you.

KEEP THIS PAGE OPEN

Trista at the Table

Level 1 quick reference

AC	HP	SPEED	INIT	ATTACK	DAMAGE
14	11	30 ft.	+4	+6	1d6+4

Default combat turn

1. Choose a target and move into reach.
2. Action: attack, d20 + 6.
3. On a hit: 1d6 + 4 damage.
4. Bonus Action: Unarmed Strike, d20 + 6.
5. On a hit: 1d6 + 4 damage.
6. Say when the turn is finished.

Common rolls

- Stealth: d20 + 6
- Acrobatics: d20 + 6
- Deception: d20 + 3
- Initiative: d20 + 4
- Death save: d20, no modifier
- Other checks: use the live sheet

When the default is wrong

ESCAPE

Disengage, then move. This prevents Opportunity Attacks caused by leaving an enemy's reach.

SURVIVE

Dodge when staying alive matters more than attacking. Tell allies when HP is low.

HELP

Use Help, protect an ally, block a doorway, call out danger, or solve the real objective.

Words you can always use

"What can Trista see from here?"

"How far away is that?"

"I want to do this - what should I roll?"

"Would moving away provoke an attack?"

"Can I help another character?"

"I am done with my turn."

REMEMBER

You are not being tested on rules knowledge. Describe what Trista wants, ask questions, and make the choice that keeps the story moving. The live sheet and the DM settle the details.